PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineer | Security Incident Response | Detection Engineering | SIEM/EDR | CISSP

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of experience in security incident response, detection engineering, and Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) operations within large enterprise environments. Currently working as Senior Cyber Security Engineer at the University of the Arts London, I lead end-to-end response to high-severity security events, conduct structured threat hunting using MITRE ATT&CK, and design detection content across CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM) and Microsoft Sentinel. I have extensive experience with Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) platforms, Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) workflows, and PowerShell-based automation to accelerate triage and reduce analyst burden. I have also supported large-scale Defender XDR deployments across 8,000 users, and I am comfortable operating in fast-paced, always-on security teams with a strong collaborative and continuous improvement mindset.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Security Incident Response and Digital Forensics (DFIR):** End-to-end incident handling, NIST SP 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK-based investigation, forensic triage, executive post-incident reporting, root cause analysis
- **SIEM and Detection Engineering:** CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel, KQL detection rule authoring, correlation logic, log onboarding, detection content lifecycle management
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR/XDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Falcon Insight, Falcon Discover, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender XDR
- **SOAR and Automation:** Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development, PowerShell scripting, automated triage workflows, alert enrichment
- **Threat Intelligence and Threat Hunting:** Proactive hunting against MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques, Falcon Insight query hunting, Sentinel hunting workbooks, IOC enrichment
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure, Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM), Tanium
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus
- **Identity Security:** BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus (CE+)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Lead end-to-end security incident response for the organisation, handling high-severity events from initial detection through containment, eradication, recovery, and post-incident review, in line with NIST SP 800-61.
- Perform structured digital forensics and incident investigation across Windows endpoints using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel, correlating telemetry to confirm scope and impact.
- Design and maintain detection engineering content across CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, authoring KQL queries and correlation rules aligned to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques.
- Build and maintain SOAR automation playbooks to accelerate alert triage, automate enrichment, and reduce mean time to respond (MTTR) for recurring alert types.
- Conduct proactive threat hunting campaigns using MITRE ATT&CK as a framework, using Falcon Insight, Sentinel hunting workbooks, and KQL to surface low-signal adversarial activity before alerts fire.
- Manage CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across all 8,000 endpoints, including policy management, sensor deployment, Prevent exclusion tuning, and Discover asset visibility.
- Produce executive-level post-incident reports and drive improvement actions, contributing to root cause analysis and long-term security posture enhancement.

- Mentor junior analysts and contribute to team knowledge sharing on threat detection, investigation techniques, and SOAR automation.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 – March 2025*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Performed day-to-day SIEM alert triage across CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, investigating and escalating high-confidence detections through to full incident response.
- Authored KQL-based detection queries and hunting rules in Microsoft Sentinel, proactively surfacing MITRE ATT&CK technique indicators across endpoint, identity, and email data sources.
- Operated Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) alert queues, tuning policies and reducing false positive rates through iterative content improvement.
- Developed PowerShell automation scripts to streamline repetitive security operations tasks including log review, user account audits, and endpoint patch verification.
- Administered BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), managing privileged account lifecycle, session recording, and just-in-time access approvals.
- Supported major incident response exercises and table-top simulations, practising end-to-end playbook execution and improving team readiness.
- Contributed to SOAR playbook design for automated containment actions triggered by high-confidence CrowdStrike and Sentinel detections.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 – March 2022*

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

- Delivered security engineering and infrastructure support for a SaaS and Financial Technology (FinTech) platform, owning endpoint protection, vulnerability scanning, and cloud security baseline management.
- Managed Microsoft Entra ID, Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM), and endpoint security policies, maintaining a strong and consistent security posture across cloud and on-premises environments.
- Conducted vulnerability scanning and risk-based remediation across application and infrastructure layers, supporting ISO 27001 compliance activities and internal audit evidence gathering.
- Responded to security alerts and potential incidents, documenting findings and coordinating remediation with engineering and infrastructure teams.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led the response to a significant phishing and credential theft incident affecting 200 accounts, containing the breach within two hours using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Entra ID conditional access lockdown.
- Designed and deployed a threat hunting programme aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, proactively identifying and containing three advanced persistent threat (APT) indicators over 18 months before they escalated to incidents.
- Built a SOAR automation library of 15 playbooks in CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) for high-severity alerts by 40%.
- Authored over 40 custom KQL detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, reducing false positive alert volume by 55% and improving analyst focus on genuine threats.
- Managed CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent and Insight across all 8,000 UAL endpoints, achieving 100% EDR coverage and reducing endpoint threat dwell time from hours to minutes.
- Developed a post-incident review process and runbook library, improving team preparedness and enabling faster recovery for recurring incident types.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+

- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Remote (UK/EMEA)